

TV MATTERS: DON'T FORGET

Beyond choosing size, resolution, and smart features, savvy buyers in India should also factor in energy-efficiency labels, warranty coverage, optimal purchase timing, advanced picture presets, and regular maintenance. These complementary insights ensure your TV not only delivers peak performance but also offers long-term value and reliability.

BEE star ratings

The Bureau of Energy Efficiency upgraded its star-rating table for colour televisions effective January 1, 2025, raising minimum efficiency thresholds by one star to curb power consumption. New regulations now require QR codes on labels to reveal detailed energy use data and country-of-origin information, helping buyers make informed, sustainable choices.

Standard vs. Extended coverage

Most manufacturers provide a standard one- to two-year warranty on TVs sold in India, covering manufacturing defects and technical failures. Retailers such as Vijay Sales offer extended warranty plans that add 12–48 months of coverage – including parts, labour, and accidental damage – for a modest premium.

Annual maintenance contracts

Consider annual maintenance contracts (AMCs) through authorised service centres to guarantee priority support, reduced labour charges, and routine check-ups that prolong panel lifespan.

When to buy

In India, major sale festivals drive the best TV discounts. Amazon's Great Freedom Festival in late July 2025 featured up to 40% off select smart TVs for Prime members. Flipkart's Big Billion Days around Diwali and Amazon Prime Day also offer comparable markdowns, often coupled with bank and exchange offers.

Studio-calibrated modes

Premium TVs now ship with Netflix Calibrated Mode or Filmmaker Mode, which lock in studio-approved color, brightness, and contrast settings for a cinema-quality picture at home.

Gaming and eye-comfort modes

Enable Game Mode with ALLM/VRR for ultra-low input lag on consoles, and use dedicated Eye-Comfort presets to reduce blue light and flicker during extended viewing sessions.

Dust management

Dust buildup behind and around vents impedes airflow and can overheat internal components; clean with a soft microfiber duster or compressed air every three months.

Screen cleaning

Avoid abrasive paper towels, which can scratch screens and leave lint; instead, use a microfiber cloth with manufacturer-approved screen cleaner to safely remove fingerprints and smudges.

3. **Select Panel Type:** Match LCD/QLED/MiniLED/OLED to room brightness and usage.
4. **Evaluate PQ Features:** HDR format support, refresh rate, VRR, ALLM, and HDMI versions.
5. **Assess Smart OS:** Pick an interface with apps and voice assistants you already use.
6. **Check Connectivity:** Ensure sufficient HDMI 2.1, USB, Ethernet, and audio ports.
7. **Set Budget & Shop:** Filter by price, read reviews, and compare offers.
8. **Calibrate Post-Setup:** Run built-in picture modes, adjust brightness, colour temperature, and use calibration discs.

Real-world setup examples

- **Family Living Room:** 65" QLED with 1.6× distance (10 ft), HDR10+ support, two HDMI 2.1 ports, and Google TV for varied content.
- **Gamer's Den:** 55" OLED at 1.5× distance (8 ft), 120 Hz panel, ALLM/VRR, three HDMI 2.1 ports, and PC/console passthrough.
- **Home Theater:** 75" MiniLED with motorized ambient-light rejection screen, Dolby Vision, AVR via eARC, and universal remote integration.

By following these guidelines – measuring accurately, understanding technical trade-offs, and aligning features with your content habits – you'll pick a TV that excels today and endures through future upgrades. 